during the NRC/CAA protests, organizations such as Karnataka Rajya Raita Sangha and the Dalit Sangharsh Samiti effectively federated themselves.

The planning of the Yatra emerged as a central rallying point for civil society organizations to mobilize their cadre in preparation for the impending assembly elections in Karnataka. Numerous meetings were convened and additional organizations were enlisted to bolster and empower the Bharat Jodo Yatra. Eminent personalities in Karnataka, including Devanur Mahadeva (a renowned Dalit writer), Noor Sridhar, Lalitha, Dr Vasu H.V. and Mallige Sirimane, united to coordinate and galvanize civil society's support for the Yatra.

As part of these initiatives, various interactions between civil society leaders and Rahul Gandhi were meticulously planned throughout his visit. In conceptualizing civil society interactions in Karnataka, there was a unanimous decision to incorporate individuals from the grassroots, affording them the opportunity to engage with Rahul Gandhi. Drawing from prior interactions, it was evident that Rahul ji derived genuine satisfaction from engaging with people at the grassroots level. He expressed a profound appreciation for the insights of the common person and actively sought to glean knowledge from these interactions.

A notable example of this occurred in Honnali, a secluded locale within a reserved forest en route to Chitradurga. The circumstances were far from ideal, as heavy rain the previous night had rendered the designated tent for the civil society interaction waterlogged and impracticable. Despite these challenging conditions, the determination of the organizers persevered. Arriving at 8 a.m., I had to navigate through slush to reach the tent. The interaction held particular significance as it had been orchestrated for exceptional women to engage with Rahul Gandhi.

In this particular interaction, meticulous efforts were made to ensure that women employed in the unorganized sector had the opportunity to converse with the leader. This decision was not without its challenges, given the unique nature of our task. Many women were found working directly at the campsite, including sanitary workers and civil construction labourers. A